

Memorandum



To:	Nick Steadman, Property Development Manager
From:	Rachael Snape, Statutory Planning Manager
CC:	Ashish Dhanjee, Transport Planner Approvals
Date:	6 June 2025
Subject:	Area 51 – Addendum Advice

This memo is provided as an addendum to earlier advice provided in relation to the proposed Area 51 development.

Where relevant this advice will supplement or amend areas of previous comments made in the memo of 21 May 2024, 14 May 2024 and are to be considered in conjunction with the Design Matters Memorandum dated 21 May 2024.

It is noted that the pack sent for consideration includes development that is not the subject of the initial assessment, as the floor area has been reduced and the night market element removed. It is advised that this unrelated component has not been considered in this addendum advice, that has focused solely on those matters highlighted for further consideration in May 2024. Commercial Property is advised that there may be implications for the future development of the residue lot that are not addressed in this advice and may impact future advice and be a risk for future development.

The addendum advice is not exhaustive and has not considered consistency with the broader requirements of Planning Guidelines. The omission of any matter covered by the Planning Guidelines not covered in the advice, should not be inferred as those matters not being relevant – it is the responsibility of the appointed Development Manager to consider the Planning Guidelines in the preparation of an application to the ALCC and ensure consistency.

Planning / Design Item	Considerations
Land use	The development has been determined to fall within the genus of an “indoor sport and recreation centre”. The use is possible in the zone. It is noted that option two includes a “food and beverage” offering where this is made available to persons who are not patrons of Area 51 it will be considered an

	independent use capable of generating its own demand. While the use is possible in the zone, if determined to be independent it may alter the parking assessment.
Building	The proposed building footprint still covers a considerable area of the overall site and does not appear to have responded to comments on 21 May 2024 stating “Consider a reduction to the overall building footprint to achieve a more balanced development within the context of the site and its surroundings”
Parking Assessment	Parking demand The Transport Planning have confirmed the Statutory Planning Managers parking demand and assessment for Area 51 as follows: Required: approx. 355 spaces Provided (on site): 84 spaces (across two potential tenancies) – assume 42 each tenancy Parking deficit: 313 spaces Notably the site has capacity for two tenancies with a cumulative floor space of 10,607m². While the second tenancy is not yet confirmed it is understood that this may be occupied by “The Racquet Club”. Both uses would be a form of “<i>indoor sport and recreation</i>” requiring 5 parking spaces per 100sqm of GFA. Considering the potential ultimate build out, parking demand and assessment based on the total quantum of floor space is as follows: Required: 531 spaces, based on the cumulative GFA of the 2 tenancies; Provided (on site): 84 spaces Parking deficit: 447 spaces. Advice Note: The Stat. Planning Manager) undertook a comparative analysis of all approved and operating Area 51 sites in Brisbane, this review confirmed the acceptability of the adopted rate, that consistently indicated the land use would generate significant parking demands. Planning advice for the operations of this parking area: - there needs to be a realistic plan on how the additional 313 vehicles will be accommodated in the Skygate precinct to support the operation of Area 51 and some consideration of the longer term impact of the second tenancy coming on line and deficit increasing to 447 spaces. - this plan should also be agreed with and communicated to the Parking and Transport Operations team. Traffic Impact Assessment A number of risks arise from the reduced parking. As such the TIA we will need to address at minimum: - operational profile/capacity of both Area 51, with a profile and capacity comparison to Home & Life and DFO - absorption capacity of the surrounding parking lots, including a breakdown of Home & Life parking and DFO parking to accommodate the overflow from the site - advice on mitigation strategies to prevent major parking demand overlaps (e.g. contractual operational hours (including for school holidays and expected busier periods), capacity caps etc.) - due to limited parking in the lot proposed, a drop-off area should be investigated

	- active transport connections are to be appropriate for the demand - including safe access from the DFO parking lot (the current access is negligible and too far to walk - expect higher rates of jaywalking without appropriate intervention). Timing of the TIA: - The TIA and parking assessment is to be provided and assessed by Planning prior to the final lease.
Access	- The Schneider Road proposed alignment will require alteration to the service access. The CAD files of the proposed alignment and the corridor to be preserved are attached. - Access via The Boulevard is to be clarified as this appears to be drawn as a 2-way, while the driveway near Home & Life appears to be one-way only. The preference would be the one-way, with egress onto The Boulevard to ensure a smoother access process once Schnieder Road is built - happy to discuss and explain this further. - Any lease agreement should make clear that the vehicle entry off schneider road/the circuit may need to be relocated at the request of BAC. - Details of the Schneider Road alignment was provided by Dan Martiri via email on 23/05/2025
Pedestrian Movements	Limited support of onsite parking has the potential to contribute to an increase in pedestrian movements within the Home and Life sub-precinct and between sub-precincts across Skygate, this will increase overtime as the balance of LotID SKG26 is activated. Consideration should be given to the movement network of pedestrians ensuring equity of access across sub-precincts (i.e. pathway gradients and removing movement barriers); pedestrian crossing position to facilitate efficient and safe movement of people. Particular attention should be had for the design of heavy movement/traffic areas having particular regard to the characteristics of the key demographic of Area 51 (young children). It may be necessary to incorporate access control measures at key points such as building exits, along the carpark and road edges to support child safety and prevent pedestrian/vehicular conflict.
Urban design	It is acknowledged that a "Design Matters" memo was prepared and provided to Commercial Property on or around 21 May 2024. The current SPM does not have access to this memo to determine the consistency of any change with the direction provided in this earlier advice. Property should engage directly with the Master Architect to confirm that building alignment; footprint and massing has adequately responded to these comments.
Draft 2026 Master Plan	As property would be aware the draft 2026 Master Plan is significantly progressed with exhibition targeted for August 2025. As part of the Master Plan process the ANEF has been reviewed and refined. The ANEF applying to the site under forthcoming master plan is ANEF20-25. In accordance with Table 2.1 of AS2021:2015 the building type is "acceptable" within the zone.